



Security Watch

Frame Injection Vulnerability

The problem

A seven year-old type of vulnerability has been inadvertently re-introduced in the latest versions of several browsers. The flaw could be used by hackers or potential fraudsters to spoof the contents of Web sites, according to security alert firm Secunia. The security bug is "moderately critical", Secunia says. It stems from a failure to check if a target frame belongs to a particular opened Web site. This allows one browser window to load content into a named frame of another window.

Opera, Mozilla, Firefox, IE, Safari and more are all affected.

The Damages

If the contents of a Web page are 'spoofed', you could be misled into thinking that the content belongs to a different, more trusted site. Successful exploitation allows a malicious Web site to load arbitrary content in an arbitrary frame in another browser window owned by, for example, a trusted site. This might lead you to give out personal details that will fall into the wrong hands, for example, or believe something that's not true.

Precautions

Secunia has a test so you can check if your browser is affected. The test is at http://secunia.com/multiple_browsers_frame_injection_vulnerability_test/

If your browser is affected, there's not much you can do except wait for a patch and browse only trusted sites.

boot directly off a USB thumb drive.

Dubbed the 'Puppy' Linux, the OS is one of dozens of custom and guerilla variants on Linux circulating across the software community. The developer of the OS, Barry Kauler, says one of the main advantages of Puppy Linux is its simplicity. "When other distributions start up, you see all these servers loading, but in Puppy, it's really basic, and bootup is remarkably fast. However, I still managed to stick to the requirement of it all loading into RAM and freeing up the CD drive," claims Kauler.

Puppy began as a hand-built distro, which Kauler pieced together file by file. "For example, my unique printing system uses PDQ and the Gimp-print IJS drivers, but is tied together with my own Printer Wizard, written in Ash," Kauler said. (PDQ is a print utility; Gimp is an image-manipulation program)

FOX IN DEER'S CLOTHING

Preview To Firefox 1.1 Released

The Mozilla Foundation has released the first preview of Firefox 1.1, dubbed 'Deer Park Alpha 1'. The name 'Deer Park', according to the Foundation, is to ward off end-users from downloading and trying the

early version. The alpha is aimed at developers, particularly those who create plug-ins—called extensions in the Firefox world—to enhance the browser. Several release candidates, including one posted prior to a recent three-day weekend in the US, led to the release of the alpha version.

"Deer Park has been made available for testing purposes only, with no end-user support," Mozilla wrote on its site. "If that sounds scary, you'd probably be better off with the latest final release Firefox 1.0.4."

Among the visible changes in Deer Park is a 'sanitise' tool that deletes all evidence of browsing. Other enhancements include image thumbnails on tabs, and a revamped 'Options' dialog box.

Those ready to ignore Mozilla's warning can download the Windows, Linux, or Max OS X versions from the foundation's site. The final Firefox 1.1 aimed at end-users will be available in July, according to information on the Web site.

CHIPPING AWAY

A Supercomp Sans Microprocessors

An experimental supercomputer constructed from hardware that can reconfigure itself

HOT



Tabbed Browsing In IE

The upcoming IE7 is supposed to have the tabbed browsing feature, and now, it turns out that you can have tabbed browsing in IE6 itself. Tabbed browsing has long been a feature of Safari, Firefox, and Opera.

NOT

The Need For The MSN Toolbar!

Tabbed browsing is available within IE6 only through the MSN Search toolbar. You need to download it and install it for tabbed browsing to work—not to mention that you need to keep it installed!

to tackle software problems is being built by researchers in Scotland. The system under construction at the Edinburgh Parallel Computing Centre at Edinburgh University will use Field Programmable Gate Array (FPGA) chips instead of conventional microprocessors.

FPGAs can be reconfigured using software to mimic computer processing equipment that is physically designed to take on specialised tasks. In contrast, conventional microprocessors are designed to act as fixed, general purpose processing devices. Each FPGA chip consists of a block of programmable logic gates that can be electronically organised into different types of circuits.



One Silly Question

What would you do if you were to become Microsoft's CEO for a day?



"Make a software that is completely bug-free"
Vinod Darole, Nashik



"Stop working"
Harsh Unadkat, Mumbai



"Speed up the release of Longhorn"
Pooja Wadhwa, Mumbai



"Spend as much money as I can!"
Kanchi Gandhi, Mumbai



"Make Microsoft Open Source"
Rohit Rangnathan, Chennai